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‘Jungle primary’ question splits Democrats

What change would mean in Mass. unclear

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Massachusetts voters will have the chance to scrap the state’s party primary system this November — a decision that has big implications for the many ambitious politicians eyeing the few top-tier offices in the state.

The referendum, which Secretary of State William Galvin on Tuesday officially certified as Question 3, would switch elections to what’s known as a jungle primary,

where all candidates, regardless of party, run in a single, nonpartisan primary, and the two top vote-getters advance to the general.

Some supporters of the change argue it could increase competition (and possibly, moderation) for top races by decreasing the power of party loyalists. Opponents say it’s a solution in search of a problem. The question has already divided Democrats within Massachusetts, and a similar schism is emerging among its federal officeholders, as well.

So far, most of the state’s congressional delegation are declining to take a position on the change. But the few who are in favor of scrapping the party primary provide a telling indication of who may benefit politically in a heavily Democratic state.

And now that the referendum is confirmed for the ballot, efforts to shape voters’ opinions of the change are likely to heat up significantly ahead of November.

Two members of the delegation said they support a jungle primary: Newton Representative Jake

Auchincloss and Salem Representative Seth Moulton.

Both are more moderate Democrats, who tend to struggle to win over the blue state’s activist-heavy primary voters. Moulton is challenging incumbent Senator Ed Markey in the Democratic primary this September, and Auchincloss considered doing so before opting against it.

Markey, on the other hand, is against the switch.

“I support keeping Democratic and Republican primaries so that

PRIMARIES, Page A6

Lawmakers consider moves for openness

Skeptics say Mass. Senate proposal, House version don’t go far enough

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts lawmakers are moving closer to widening the state’s public records laws, with the Senate preparing to vote on legislation that would make some of the Legislature’s own records available as well as those of the governor’s office.

The Senate proposal is similar to one passed by the House in June. Both come after years of public criticism over a lack of transparency on Beacon Hill, and just months before voters will weigh a ballot question that would open up much more of the Legislature’s records to the public.

But while Democratic leaders and several good-government groups cast the legislative proposals as recognition of the public’s right to know, sponsors of the ballot proposal took a dimmer view, arguing the measures would reveal little about the Legislature’s workings that the public can’t already get.

Unlike the version passed by the House, the Senate proposal would not specifically exempt the Legislature from the existing public records law. But similarly, it would allow the public access to 19 categories of documents and information, ranging from legislator salaries to ethics disclosures to third-party audit reports.

“By writing the Legislature and the Governor into the public records law, we are affirming that

RECORDS, Page A7

Tracy’s message helped turn Red Sox around

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

How to measure interim manager Chad Tracy’s contribution to the dramatic and now historic Red Sox midsummer U-turn that turned a last-place team into an unstoppable force? Start with the night of June 22.

The Sox suffered a startling 3-2 loss to the worst team in baseball when closer Aroldis Chapman yielded a walkoff, three-run triple to the Rockies. Despite improved play, the Sox repeatedly found novel ways to lose, yielding a 31-45 record and making the playoffs seem remote.

In his hotel room after that loss, Tracy — who hates team meetings, and almost never holds them — felt a need to connect with his players.

“There may be times where something’s on your heart,” said Tracy. “You’re sitting there in your room [thinking], ‘If I’m feeling this way, maybe they need to hear from me.’”

Tracy periodically uses team-wide messages. In Denver, he sent a middle-of-the-night missive. The gist?

“I’m not going to turn on you. I know what you’re going through. I’ve been here. All these losses, we’re doing it together, and we’re going to find a way to win together,” Tracy recounted. “When you guys are roll-

TRACY, Page C2



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Courtney Walker, shown with her husband and children, struggled to find the right treatment for her postpartum depression.

IN THE ‘FOURTH TRIMESTER,’ MENTAL HEALTH CHALLENGES

Women facing postpartum issues can’t always get the help they need in Mass.

By Sarah Rahal and Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

and Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As jurors prepare to weigh whether Lindsay Clancy is guilty of first-degree murder in the deaths of her children, a second question hangs over her trial: Can women with severe postpartum mental health symptoms get the full range of care they need in Massachusetts?

Clancy, 35, has admitted that she killed the three young children in January 2023, then jumped from a second-floor window of her house in an attempt to kill herself.

She is mounting an insanity defense, claiming she was in the throes of severe postpartum mental illness and could not resist a voice in her head telling her to kill her chil-

dren and herself. She and her ex-husband, Patrick Clancy, argue in separate lawsuits against her health care providers that she was misdiagnosed, shuffled among practitioners, and overmedicated with around a dozen different prescriptions, many of which made her symptoms worse.

►Jury seated in Clancy case. B3.

If Clancy, a labor and delivery nurse at Massachusetts General Hospital, could not find appropriate care, one might wonder, what are the odds of other moms, especially those less savvy about the medical system, getting the treatment they need?

In the three years since Clancy was charged, Massachusetts has adopted a sweeping maternal health law that has expanded postpartum depression screening re-

quirements, promoted postpartum home visits, and made online resources, including support groups and a state postpartum help hot line, 866-472-1897, more widely available.

Yet there is so much more that could be done, patients and clinicians said: more specialized outpatient programs, additional psychiatrists who specialize in reproductive health, better training for obstetricians and pediatricians to recognize severe postpartum mental illness, and dedicated mother-baby psychiatric units that allow mothers to receive inpatient care while remaining with their infants.

As important, there’s an effort underway nationally to add a diagnosis of postpartum psychosis to the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, the authorita-

POSTPARTUM, Page A10

A vision of the future with new Sagamore Bridge

Wider lanes, protected areas for cyclists on tap

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The Cape Cod Bridges megaproject will produce not only a new Sagamore Bridge, state officials say, but a completely different one.

The \$2.1 billion span will be “both wider and longer” than the 91-year-old bridge now connecting Cape Cod and mainland Massachusetts, said Luisa Paiewonsky, executive director of megaproject delivery for the state Department of Transportation.

Renderings released Thursday by state officials offered detailed looks at the two 12-foot travel lanes that will go both directions, plus an additional lane on each side for entering and exiting vehicles and an expanded shoulder.

The bridge will also include a barrier-protected pathway for pedestrians and cyclists that will be 14 feet wide at its narrowest point, with a bench at a lookout facing west — toward the sunset, Paiewonsky said — at the bridge’s midpoint.

Construction could begin late next year on the new bridge, which will feature a variety of other differences from its predecessor.

SAGAMORE, Page A10



DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

A rendering shows the modern structure that will replace the current bridge, which is nearly a century old.



Double vision

Friday: Another perfect day. High 77-82. Low 62-67.

Saturday: And another one. High 75-80. Low 59-64.

Sunrise: 5:29 Sunset: 8:12

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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The price of oil hit \$100 a barrel for the first time since May after militants allied with Iran said they had hit two Saudi tankers. **A3.**

The FDA has identified a new outbreak of cyclosporiasis that has sickened at least 72 people, in the worst year on record for the intestinal illness. **A2.**

The North End Historical Museum opened this week after years of efforts to preserve the neighborhood’s unique history. **B1.**

The Newport Folk Festival this weekend has plenty of big names, but there are many lesser-known performers you should check out. Here are 10. **G1.**